

Concluding Remarks

The only drawback about betting on the new horse is you never know if it can run the distance. The same risk applies to relatively unknown hosts, the time spent blogging at these sites may come cropper if the site were to close down unexpectedly. Nonetheless, the features offered by blog-city.com give it a good chance to thrive.

1.10.4 LiveJournal

Livejournal is an open source blogging platform which forms the basis of the Livejournal.com site. Originally created by Danga Software, this was bought by Six Apart, a company that also develops the blogging platform Moveable Type and runs Typepad.com.

Unlike other blogging platforms discussed, Livejournal has a strong social networking flavour with terms like “friends” and “community” given prominence on the site. We shall be focusing on the blogging platform only. While seemingly lightweight in comparison to Blogger and WordPress, LiveJournal (LJ) has a few tricks up its sleeve.

To create a blog you need to sign up on the site. LJ offers three types of services, of which the most features are available for the Paid one. Of the other two free services the one offering most features (called “Plus”) is selected by default, when you sign up. This one is ad supported, so you have to pay the “price” for the additional features. The other free version, called Basic, is ad-free.

Once you are logged in, the Journal Tab on the top banner reveals all operations you can do with the blog.

The Client

The Post Entry and Edit Entry link under the Journal tab form the LJ client. The text box by default shows the HTML editor, which means you can directly put in HTML code. In case you are not well-versed with HTML, you can type in as usual and LJ will automatically format the text with the relevant HTML notation. This auto-formatting can be disabled also. You can switch to the more famil-